This Bulletin covers the degree requirements for students matriculating in the current academic year. Students who matriculated before the current year can find their requirements in the relevant archived Bulletin.

The PhD in business administration involves two years of formal courses established by each Department and approved by the Doctoral Committee. Students take a minimum of 45 credits during their program, including 27 credits in core courses, a 3-credit summer paper, and 15 credits in elective courses. Students should consult their Faculty Advisory Group about the required courses and electives for which they should register.

Students should complete at least 39 credits within the first two years from matriculation. The remaining 6 credits should be completed during the third year.

Requirements for the information systems and technology management concentration

The following 30 credits constitute the core requirements for the information systems and technology management concentration*:	
Four courses (12 credits) in research methods and quantitative analysis.	
ECON 8301	Microeconomic Theory I
ECON 8375	Econometrics I
ECON 8376	Econometrics II
MGT 8385	Special Topics in Research Methods
Four doctoral seminars (12 credits) covering important studies in the student's area of interest, selected from the following:	
ISTM 8391	Contemporary Research Topics in Information Systems
ISTM 8392	Empirical Research in Information Systems, Cross-Disciplinary Overview
ISTM 8393	Behavioral Theories in Information Systems Research
ISTM 8394	Advanced Empirical Methods in Information Systems
ISTM 8395	Research in Digital Business Strategy
One additional doctoral-level seminar (3 credits) from outside the student's area of interest	

Completion of a 3-credit summer research paper during the first or first and second summer, as required by the student's area of interest.

Electives

The remaining 15 credits required are taken in elective courses, selected in consultation with the student's faculty advisory group.

***Policies for core courses**

In general, all core courses should be doctoral courses, i.e., those at the 8000 level. All courses must be taken for letter grades. Required courses cannot be waived without substitution except in unusual circumstances as determined on a case-by-case basis. Examples of unusual circumstances include students holding a specialized master's or doctoral degree where equivalent core courses were taken in a particular area (such as statistics or mathematics). Students may petition the Associate Dean of Research and Doctoral Programs to substitute up to 12 credits of required courses with alternative courses approved by the faculty advisory group.

Comprehensive examination

After the student completes the coursework and the summer paper requirements, the faculty advisory group and department faculty administer a comprehensive examination. The format of the comprehensive examination is at the discretion of the advisory committee, subject to approval by the doctoral committee when evaluating the study plan. The comprehensive examination establishes the student’s mastery of the current and classic literature. The comprehensive exam can be written, in-class or take-home, and may include an oral component. Failure to pass the comprehensive examination in two attempts leads to termination from the program.

Dissertation

Following successful completion of the comprehensive examination, the student is considered a doctoral candidate, and may form a dissertation committee, and develop a dissertation proposal. During this stage, students prepare, submit, and defend a dissertation.

Other policies

All course work and required comprehensive examination must be completed within five years of matriculation. All program requirements must be completed within seven years of the date of matriculation.

The doctoral program is administered and supervised by the Associate Dean and the committee on doctoral studies. For more detailed information about this program, contact the GWSB Doctoral Program Office.